

Photographer Tracker

Setup & User Guide · Photographers & videographers · per-shoot profit + IRS Schedule C · works in Excel & Google Sheets

What you bought

A single, formula-driven spreadsheet that does your photography business bookkeeping for you. Log each transaction once, and the workbook automatically organizes everything into a tax-ready **IRS Schedule C** summary and a live profit dashboard — per shoot. No subscriptions, no logins, no monthly fees. It's yours forever.

The 6 tabs

Tab	What it's for
Start Here	A one-page overview and tips. Read this first.
Setup	Type your shoot names (up to 5). Everything else links to them automatically.
Transactions	Your logbook. Add one row per income or expense. The only tab you touch daily.
Categories	Reference list of every category and its matching Schedule C line. Feeds the dropdowns.
Schedule C Summary	Fills itself in. Every expense mapped to the correct Schedule C line, per shoot.
Dashboard	Live totals: net profit, income vs. expenses, by shoot and by month.

Get started in 4 steps

- **1. Name your shoots.** Open the **Setup** tab and type each shoot name in column B (replace the sample names). You can have up to 5.
- **2. Delete the sample data.** The **Transactions** tab has 8 example rows so you can see how it works. Once you understand it, delete those rows (select rows 4–11, right-click, Delete) before adding your own.
- **3. Log a transaction.** On **Transactions**, fill one row: pick the Date, choose the Shoot and Type (Income / Expense) from the dropdowns, pick a Category, enter the Amount. The Month column fills in by itself.
- **4. Read your reports.** Open **Schedule C Summary** and **Dashboard** any time — they update the instant you add a row. Nothing to refresh.

How to log it the right way (important)

- **Log each session or shoot fee as income** (*Session / shoot fee*) and tag it to that shoot on the Setup tab — the dashboard then shows profit per shoot, your most useful number.
- **Print and album sales are income** (*Print & album sales*); the cost of the prints/albums you buy to fulfill them goes under *Prints, albums & packaging (COGS)*.

- **Big-ticket gear (cameras, lenses) is usually depreciated** or expensed under Section 179, not written off all at once — log it under *Camera gear & equipment* and confirm the treatment with your tax pro.
- **Tag shoot-specific costs to the shoot** (second shooter, travel, props) and general costs — marketing, software, studio rent — to **(General / business)**.

Use it in Excel or Google Sheets

Excel / Numbers: just open the .xlsx file.

Google Sheets: go to Google Drive → New → File upload → select the .xlsx. Then open it and choose *File* → *Save as Google Sheets*. All formulas, dropdowns and reports carry over.

Each tax year

Keep one file per year. At the start of a new year, make a copy and rename it (e.g. “Photographer Tracker 2027”), then clear the Transactions rows. Your prior year stays untouched for your records.

Disclaimer. This template is a bookkeeping organizer, not tax, legal, or accounting advice. The Schedule C line mapping is provided for convenience only. Tax rules vary by situation and jurisdiction — always confirm your specific filing with a qualified tax professional before submitting. Made with spreadsheet software; design and formulas by the seller.